V-Dem
VARIETIES OF DEMOCRACY

The V-Dem Dataset

Includes the world's most comprehensive and detailed democracy ratings. The latest version of the dataset and associated reference documents can be downloaded free of charge below.

Download the data

Each ZIP includes: Dataset, Codebook, What's New, Cautionary Notes, and Suggested Citations.

Country-Year: V-Dem Full+Others

All 531 V-Dem indicators and 251 indices + 62 other indicators from other data sources. For R users, we recommend to install our vdemdata R package (https://github.com/vdeminstitute/vdemdata) which includes the most recent V-Dem dataset and some useful functions to explore the data.

Version	16
Published	March 2026
Formats	STATA, CSV, R, SPSS

Download Country-Year: V-Dem (/data/the-v-dem-dataset/country-year-v-

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Full+Others dem-fullothers-v16/)

Country-Year: V-Dem Core

The five high-level V-Dem democracy indices, 93 sub-indices, and the 179 indicators constituting them.

Version	16
Published	March 2026
Formats	STATA, CSV, R, SPSS

Download Country-Year: V-Dem Core (/data/the-v-dem-dataset/country-year-v-dem-core-v16/)

Country-Date: V-Dem

Includes 531 V-Dem indicators and 95 indices.

Version	16
Published	March 2026
Formats	STATA, CSV, R, SPSS

Download Country-Date: V-Dem (/data/the-v-dem-dataset/country-date-v-dem-v16/)

Coder-Level: V-Dem

Data coded by Country Experts and coder-reliability scores from the Measurement Model output. Includes 273 indicators.

Version	16
Published	March 2026
Formats	CSV, R

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R user?

For R users, we recommend to install our vdemdata R package (https://github.com/vdeminstitute/vdemdata) (link to Github), which includes the most recent V-Dem dataset and some useful functions to explore the data.

Reference Documents



Codebook

(/documents/70/codebook_v16.pdf)



Methodology

(/documents/71/methodology_v16.pdf)

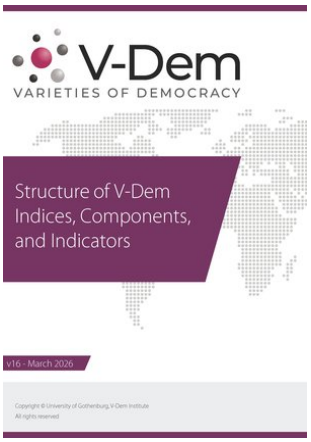


Country Coding Units

(/documents/72/countryunit_v16.pdf)

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Structure of Aggregation (/documents/73/structure_of_aggregation_V16.pdf)



Organization and Management (/documents/74/Organization_Management_v16.p

Frequently Asked Questions

Click here for more FAQ(/about/faq/)

Further Questions?

V-Dem is committed to full transparency and we are constantly working to improve our data. Please contact us if you have any questions regarding our datasets.

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